

Proposal for Khaptad National Park Development and Promotion

1. Introduction

Khaptad National Park, located in the far-western region of Nepal, spans across Bajhang, Bajura, Achham, and Doti districts. It was established in 1984 and covers an area of 225 square kilometers. The park is named after the revered hermit Khaptad Baba, who spent years meditating in the area. The park is known for its rich biodiversity, scenic landscapes, and cultural significance.

2. Objectives

- To conserve and promote biodiversity and natural resources.
- To develop eco-friendly tourism infrastructure.
- To promote cultural and religious tourism centered around Khaptad Baba.
- To enhance local community participation in conservation and tourism.
- To ensure sustainable development of the region through tourism-based livelihood programs.

3. Background and Significance

Khaptad National Park lies at an elevation of 1,400 to 3,300 meters and hosts diverse flora and fauna, including rhododendrons, Himalayan black bears, leopards, musk deer, and numerous bird species. The park also includes the sacred Khaptad Baba Ashram, a religious site that attracts pilgrims every year. Despite its natural and cultural importance, the park remains under-promoted and faces challenges such as limited accessibility, lack of facilities, and low tourism awareness.

4. Proposed Activities

1. Infrastructure Development

- Construction of eco-friendly lodges and campsites.
- Development of trekking trails and view towers.
- Installation of signboards and information centers.

2. Promotion and Awareness

- Conduct digital marketing campaigns and tourism fairs.
- Collaborate with media for promotion.
- Publish brochures, maps, and virtual tours.

3. Community Engagement

- Training for local guides and homestay operators.
- Capacity-building programs for sustainable tourism.
- Support local handicrafts and cultural programs.

4. Conservation Initiatives

- Strengthen anti-poaching patrols.
- Promote reforestation and waste management.
- Conduct biodiversity research and monitoring.

5. Expected Outcomes

- Increased tourist flow and economic opportunities for local communities.
- Enhanced conservation of biodiversity and cultural heritage.

- Improved infrastructure and accessibility.
- Strengthened local ownership and capacity for sustainable management.

6. Budget Estimate (Summary)

Activity	Estimated Cost (NPR)
Infrastructure Development	10,000,000
Promotion & Awareness	3,000,000
Community Training & Support	2,000,000
Conservation Programs	2,000,000
Total Estimated Budget	17,000,000

7. Conclusion

The development and promotion of Khaptad National Park will contribute significantly to environmental conservation, sustainable tourism, and local livelihood improvement. Collaborative efforts among government bodies, NGOs, and local communities will ensure the long-term success of this initiative.

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